Druid feature – Wild Shape · SRD 5.2.1

Wild Shape turns you into a **beast** you have learned. It's a **bonus action**. You gain **temporary HP** equal to your druid level, keep your **type**, **HP** and **mental ability scores**, but take on the beast's physical statistics.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Bonus action**, 2 uses at level 2.
2. **Temp HP** = druid level.
3. Duration: **half druid level in hours**.
4. No **spells** in beast form (before level 18).

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 removes the 2014 hour cap, grants **temp HP** at each transformation and sets learned forms (four at the start).

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say whether the form can speak. Fix: the DM rules by beast (a parrot mimics, a wolf doesn't).

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can ask the druid to describe their form at each transformation.

Step 1 – Choose:

From your **known forms** (4 at level 2, beasts of CR ≤ 1/4 without flight).

Step 2 – Transform:

Bonus action. You gain temp HP equal to your druid level.

Step 3 – Replace:

Your statistics become the beast's; you keep type, HP, Int, Wis, Cha, proficiencies, features and languages.

Step 4 – Gear:

It falls, merges or is worn at the druid's choice; it doesn't resize.

Step 5 – End:

Bonus action, or when you're Incapacitated, die, or the duration ends.

Example: Faelan, druid 4, becomes a bear (4 temp HP). He takes 6 damage: 4 temp HP and 2 real HP are lost.

Element	In beast form
Creature type	Kept
HP and Hit Dice	Kept (+ temp HP)
Int, Wis, Cha	Kept
Proficiencies (skills, saves)	Kept; use the better
Strength, Dex, Con, AC, speed	The beast's
Spells	Not possible (except level 18)
Equipment	Falls, merges or is worn

⚠ Common questions:

Which action to transform?

A bonus action.

Can I cast spells?

No, before level 18.

Does Concentration break?

No.

What do I keep?

Type, HP, Int, Wis, Cha, proficiencies, features, languages.

And my gear?

Your choice: falls, merges or is worn.

How many HP does the form have?

Yours, plus temp HP.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Speaking in beast form

Can I speak? **Option**: no, unless a talking beast.

Armor

Does armor keep its AC? **Option**: no, use the beast's AC.

Swapping forms

Can I change known forms? **Option**: yes after a Long Rest.

Flying beast

Before level 8? **Option**: no.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Incapacitated

Being Incapacitated ends the form.

Spells

Beast form blocks spells, except at level 18.

Sources

Rules from SRD 2024 and secondary guides: to be checked.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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